ACAD 324 · PROJECT 4B · IDEATION AND SELECTION

SOUNDCHECK

YOUR FRIENDS. THEIR MUSIC. ONE VERY COMPETITIVE QUIZ.

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OUR SPRINGBOARD FROM P4A

WHERE WE STARTED

HOW MIGHT WE

HOW MIGHT WE TURN THE MUSIC FRIENDS LISTEN TO ALONE INTO SOMETHING THEY PLAY TOGETHER, SO THEY FIND OUT WHAT THEY SHARE?

PROBLEM STATEMENT

College friends each have a music identity, but listening stats get looked at alone and group music talk stays informal. They want a low-pressure way to find what they share and surprise each other.

Problem wording from our P4a deck: "Listening stats are usually consumed alone. Group music conversations stay informal."

HOW WE IDEATED

FIVE PROMPTS TO BRAINSTORM AROUND

1. How might we make a friend's taste a puzzle the group solves?
2. How might we turn listening history into a reason to text the group?
3. How might we make Wrapped happen with friends instead of alone?
4. How might we let friends discover music through each other?
5. How might we make music taste something you compete on?

Methods from class: round robin, Crazy 8s, extreme scenarios, storyboarding.



THE BOARD, PART 1 · GAMES AND QUIZZES

GET WEIRD

QUIZ Live party quiz built from everyone's real Spotify stats	**QUIZ** "Whose song is this?" plays a 5-second clip, guess the friend	**HABIT** One question a day dropped in the group chat, with streaks	**GAME** Music Guess Who: flip down friends by taste clues	**GAME** Draft night: each friend drafts artists, scores by real plays all month
GAME Fantasy league for artists your friends are about to blow up on	**GAME** Higher or lower: who played Drake more this month?	**GAME** Bingo card of the group's top songs at a party	**EXTREME** Your aux privileges are earned by quiz score	**EXTREME** A courtroom: the group votes on your guilty-pleasure song
ROAD TRIP Each exit, the car guesses whose song comes next	**PARTY** A TV mode so the whole room plays on one screen	**DUEL** 1v1 taste duel, loser makes the winner a playlist	**SEASON** Weekly room, season standings all semester	**CARDS** End-of-game cards: Most Loyal, Biggest Song Looper

Starter board

THE BOARD, PART 2 · SHARING, DISCOVERY, IDENTITY

GET WACKY

MAP
A taste map of the friend group: who overlaps, who's an outlier

SCORE
Compatibility score between two friends' listening

PLAYLIST
Auto playlist of only the songs the whole group loves

WRAPPED
Group Wrapped every month, made to post

DISCOVERY
Swap week: listen only to a friend's top 10 and rate it

DISCOVERY
Recommend a song, earn points when your friend saves it

IDENTITY
Your "music persona" card, voted by friends, not the algorithm

LIVE
See what friends are playing right now on a shared screen

DATING
Match people at a party by taste overlap

LONG DISTANCE
Friends at other schools play a weekly round

CONCERT
Who in the group should go to which show together

EXTREME
A taste "horoscope" for the week from your plays

PHYSICAL
A printed trading card of your top artist stats

CAMPUS
Dorm floor vs dorm floor listening battle

ARCHIVE
Time capsule: guess what you were looping a year ago

Starter board

SORTING THE BOARD · AFFINITY DIAGRAM

FOUR CLUSTERS

PLAY LIVE

Party quiz, TV mode, bingo, road trip guessing, duels

COME BACK DAILY

Daily question, streaks, seasons, fantasy draft

SEE THE GROUP

Taste map, compatibility, group Wrapped, shared playlist

DISCOVER

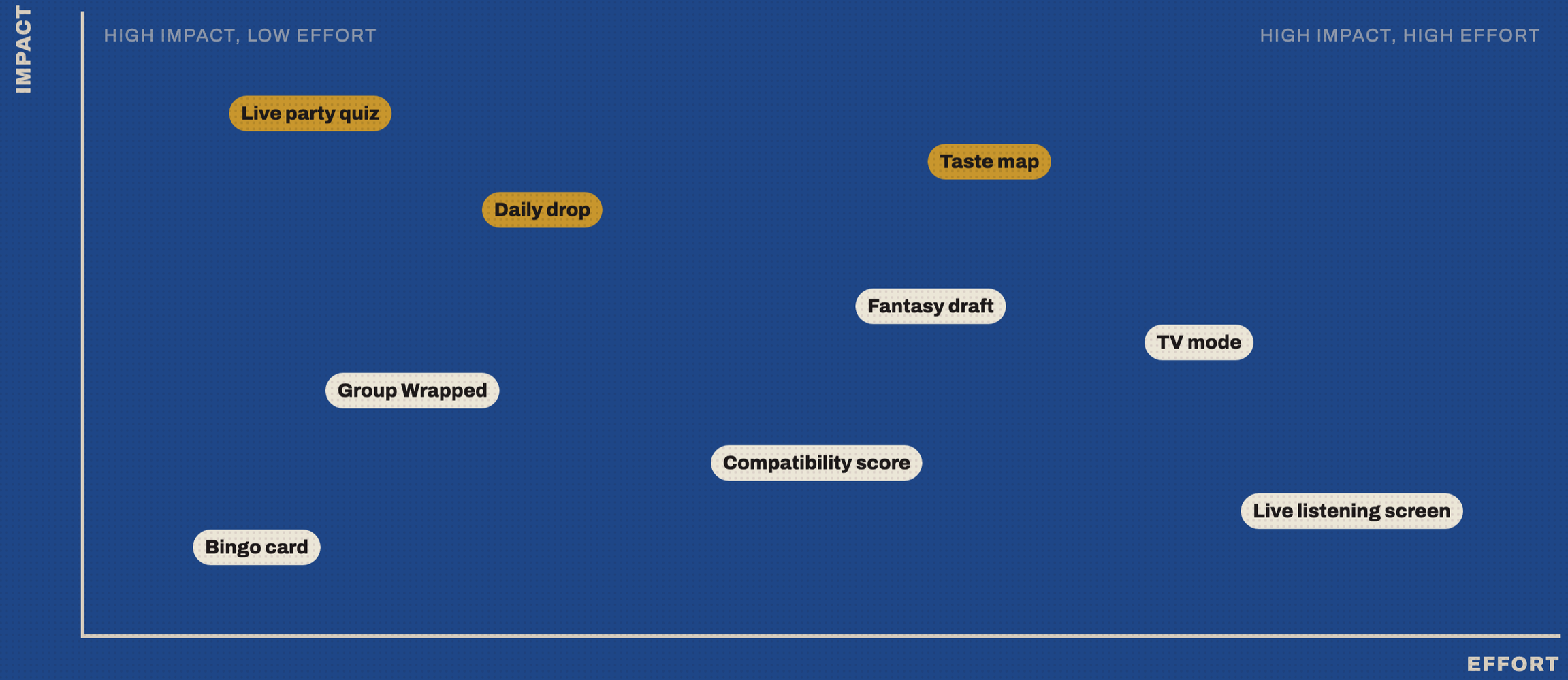
Swap week, recommend and earn, concert matching

We pulled one strong option from each of the first three clusters. Discovery ideas mostly needed one of the other three to exist first.



EFFORT / IMPACT SCALE

WHAT'S WORTH BUILDING



Draft placement

TOP 3 · OPTION A · PLAY LIVE

LIVE PARTY QUIZ

FRIENDS JOIN A PRIVATE ROOM, CONNECT SPOTIFY, AND ANSWER QUESTIONS ONLY FRIENDS COULD GET RIGHT.

- "Whose #1 song this month is Espresso?"
- Points for right answers, plus points when friends guess you
- Ends on game cards: Most Loyal Listener, Top 0.5%
- Best for: a dorm hang, a party, a road trip



TOP 3 · OPTION B · COME BACK DAILY

DAILY DROP

ONE QUESTION A DAY LANDS IN THE GROUP CHAT. EVERYONE ANSWERS ON THEIR OWN TIME, AND STREAKS KEEP THE GROUP PLAYING.

- Like Wordle, but the answer is one of your friends
- No one has to be in the same room
- Weekly standings in the chat
- Best for: long-distance friends, busy weeks

TOP 3 · OPTION C · SEE THE GROUP

TASTE MAP

A LIVING MAP OF THE FRIEND GROUP'S MUSIC: WHO OVERLAPS, WHO'S THE OUTLIER, AND A PLAYLIST OF THE SONGS EVERYONE SHARES.

- Compatibility score for every pair of friends
- Updates each month like a group Wrapped
- Made to screenshot and post
- Best for: end of semester, new friend groups



FEEDBACK ON OUR TOP 3

WHAT PEOPLE TOLD US

LIVE QUIZ

Feedback to collect in P4c

DAILY DROP

Feedback to collect in P4c

TASTE MAP

Feedback to collect in P4c

Rubric: get feedback on the top 3 before selecting. Fastest real source: 3 to 5 friends play the prototype at playsoundcheck.up.railway.app, then pick which of the three they'd open again.

SELECTION · SCORED 1 TO 5 ON THE CLASS CRITERIA

PICKING A WINNER

OPTION	FEASIBILITY	NOVELTY	IMPACT	RELEVANCE	FITS OUR HMW	TOTAL
A · Live party quiz	**5**	**4**	**4**	**5**	**5**	**23**
B · Daily drop	4	3	3	4	4	18
C · Taste map	3	2	3	3	3	14

Feasibility: A already runs as a prototype. Spotify's Development Mode caps sign-ins at 5 accounts, so A added quick picks and data uploads as other ways in.

Novelty: Wrapped is alone and Spotify Blend already makes shared playlists, which hurts C. Live trivia exists, but not built from your friends' own data.

Impact: A starts a conversation in the room. B is lighter. C is something you look at, not do.

Draft scores, to average across the team

OUR SELECTION

SOUNDCHECK, THE LIVE PARTY QUIZ

HOW IT ANSWERS THE HMW

It takes each friend's own listening history and turns it into questions the group answers together, out loud, in one room.

HOW IT ANSWERS THE PS

Stats stop being something you look at alone. Every round reveals something about a friend, and the cards at the end give the group a story to argue about.

What we kept from the others: B's season standings (a room that keeps working each week) and C's shareable results card.

WHO DID WHAT

TEAM CONTRIBUTIONS

SAM

Design (digital), slides

MAIA

Dev and tech, organization

Built an alternate group-scheduling concept with Figma and docs

MIA

Design, sketches

Flagged the deadline, checked our ideas against Instinct, called the vote

CALEB

Generalist

Built the working prototype at playsoundcheck.up.railway.app and drafted this deck

KAYLIE

Writing and research

Roles from our P4a team norms.

